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APPLIED AI PRODUCT & OPERATING SYSTEMS

Earn the right to scale.

A discovery-first plan for building an applied AI product portfolio inside a high-touch services business.

Operating Principles

Workflow before technology

Anchor product work in recurring decisions, friction, client outcomes, and real user behavior.

Human authority is product design

Make review, escalation, overrides, and accountability explicit.

Adoption is a launch criterion

Design for account-team habits, training, incentives, and support from the start.

Evidence earns scale

Baseline quality, cycle time, use, economics, and client effect before target-setting.

Days 0-30 | Listen & Instrument

- Build a workflow map across APVision, analytics, account management, publisher development, influencer, reporting, opportunity/risk review, and leadership decisions.
- Interview users and leaders to identify recurring work, hidden judgment, workarounds, current AI use, and adoption friction.
- Document data sources, permission boundaries, confidential context, model/tool dependencies, and human decision rights.
- Inventory current products, prototypes, prompts, agents, vendors, experiments, and unofficial workarounds without shaming shadow innovation.
- Establish baseline measurement categories and owners; do not invent targets before the baseline exists.

Outputs by Day 30

Workflow map | AI product/experiment inventory | stakeholder and decision-rights map | trust/data boundary register | baseline measurement plan | top opportunity hypotheses.

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Prove & Package

Days 31-60 | Prove the Fold

- Select 2-3 opportunity hypotheses that represent different dispositions: one Assist, one Agentize, and one Productize candidate.
- Write product briefs covering client outcome, user/job, current workflow, trust boundary, human authority, reusable context, evidence, owner, and stop conditions.
- Prototype inside the workflow with representative users; test retrieval/context quality, decision usefulness, failure modes, and interaction burden.
- Define evaluation rubrics with domain experts; capture accepted/rejected recommendations and the reasons, not only model output quality.
- Run adoption rehearsals: onboarding, support, escalation, audit trail, and rollback.

Outputs by Day 60

Three evidence-backed product briefs | prototypes | evaluation rubrics | adoption plan | risk/control review | explicit fund/hold/stop recommendation.

Days 61-90 | Package & Ship

- Ship the strongest bounded capability with named product, data, workflow, human-decision, benefit, and support owners.
- Package reusable components: context schemas, prompt/agent behaviors, evaluation sets, audit events, user guidance, and release criteria.
- Instrument active use, workflow penetration, cycle time, rework, decision acceptance, quality, and support burden.
- Establish a weekly product/value review that separates feature status from realized operating benefit.
- Retire or hold work that lacks evidence rather than allowing experiments to become permanent maintenance obligations.

Outputs by Day 90

Bounded production release | reusable product assets | telemetry | enablement and support system | operating review cadence | learning record.

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Compound the Learning

Days 91-120 | Portfolio Operating System

- Establish the Service-to-Product Fold as a common product review language, not a bureaucratic gate.
- Create a portfolio view that distinguishes internal enablement, client-facing differentiation, foundational platform work, and experiments.
- Connect roadmap priority to client outcome, trust, reuse, adoption, economics, and evidence - not executive enthusiasm alone.
- Launch a reuse library for approved context schemas, evaluations, agent behaviors, controls, and product components.
- Build a quarterly evidence narrative for leadership: value realized, work retired, reuse gained, trust incidents avoided, user behavior learned, and next bets.

Executive Scorecard

Dimension | Example units - establish baseline first | Owner

Client outcome | Revenue/conversion contribution, qualified opportunity, risk avoided, decision quality | Client/business owner

Work economics | Minutes/hours, cycle time, rework, support effort, reuse count | Workflow + finance owner

Adoption | Active intended users, repeat use, workflow penetration, accepted action | Product + team leader

Trust / quality | Review result, precision, false alerts, exceptions, incidents | Product + control owner

Learning | Time to evidence, assumptions retired, assets harvested | Product owner

Day-120 Decision

Leadership should have a product portfolio with clearer ownership, evidence, reuse, and economics; one or more capabilities embedded in real work; a transparent stop/hold discipline; and a roadmap that makes the link between proprietary data, expert service, and applied AI legible.

All company-specific actions are hypotheses for discovery and must be adapted to AP's actual systems, users, governance, and priorities.